Seat Allocator

Instructions for printing seat stickers and exporting a numbered seating list

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1. Printing Seat Stickers

Stickers show each student's name, course/instructor, and seat - peel one off and place it on that student's exam.

1. Open the Seat Allocator page in any web browser. It works fully offline once loaded - no installation or internet connection needed.
2. Select your room from the **Classroom** dropdown.
3. Enter your class size in **Students**.
4. *(Optional)* List any seats to skip (e.g. broken chairs) in **Leave empty**, such as `A5, H12`.
5. Choose a **Seating style**:
   a. **Spread out (exam spacing)** - the default. Picks seats as far apart as possible for exam integrity, skipping some seats to keep distance between students.
   b. **Dense, from the front (shared room)** - for sharing a room with another class or instructor. Fills seats with no gaps, starting at row A/B and working toward the back, so your class stays clustered at the front instead of spread across the whole room.
   c. **By instructor/section, dense from the front (shared room)** - same dense, front-packed filling, but groups students by instructor and section first (see step 8 below) so each instructor's - and within that, each section's - students land together in one unbroken block, never mixed with another instructor's or section's students.
   d. **By instructor/section, spread out (shared room)** - each instructor/section gets its own zone of the room, sized to its share of the roster, and within that zone seats are spread out for exam spacing instead of packed solid - sections stay physically separated but aren't clustered together. This style needs your roster pasted or uploaded *before* you click Allocate Seats (step 8), since it has to know each section's size to size the zones - the Students field above is ignored.
6. Click **Allocate Seats**. This picks seats for your class size, using whichever seating style you chose, and shows the classroom map.
7. Scroll down and click **Print seat stickers with student names** to open that section.
8. Paste your roster into the text box, or click **Or upload a roster file** and choose a `.txt`, `.csv`, `.xlsx`, `.docx`, or `.pdf` file instead - **one student per line, in the same order as the Roster (TXT) download** (see Section 2). Use this format:

   ```
   Last, First [Middle][, Course-Section]
   ```

   For example, two student names on two separate lines:

   ```
   Doe, Jane, MATH 140-510
   Smith, John, Math 140-510
   ```
9. A header row (e.g. `Last Name, First Name, Section`) and a placeholder `Test Student` row are both detected and skipped automatically, so an exported spreadsheet or document doesn't need to be

cleaned up first. For a `.xlsx` or `.docx` upload, only the first sheet or table is read; for a `.pdf`, column layout is reconstructed from the exported text, which works for a simple roster table but isn't guaranteed for an elaborate one, and a scanned (image-only) PDF can't be read at all - check the roster box after uploading either one.

10. *(Optional)* To pin one particular student to an exact seat instead of letting Allocate Seats choose - for example, an accommodation seat - add the seat ID as a 4th column. That student's seat is used exactly as given, bypassing randomization for them only:

    ```
    Cooper, Evan, Math 151-501, D12
    ```

11. *(Optional)* That same 4th column can instead carry that one student's own **instructor's last name** (anything typed there that isn't a seat ID) - labelling them with their own instructor instead of the single **Instructor Last Name** field below (step 12). Use this for a roster shared across several instructors, e.g. Jones teaching sections 510 and 512, Peters teaching 523, 500 and 511, all pasted together in one shared-room roster. Combine it with the "By instructor/section" seating style (step 5) so each instructor's students are also seated together, not interleaved. An instructor only needs to be typed **once per section** - every other line sharing that same section picks it up automatically, pinned seats included, so Charlie below doesn't need to repeat "Jones" even though she's pinned to D9:

    ```
    Alpha, Anna, MATH 140-510, Jones
    Bravo, Ben, MATH 140-510
    Charlie, Cara, MATH 140-510, D9
    Delta, Dan, MATH 140-523, Peters
    ```

12. *(Optional)* Enter your last name in **Instructor Last Name**. It's added to the course line (e.g. `MATH 140-523-Jones`) for any student who doesn't have their own instructor from the 4th column above. If a student's course/section is left blank on purpose (for example, to withhold section information for some students), your name still appears on its own.

13. *(Optional)* Check **Print full first name** to print each student's whole first name instead of just an initial - useful when two students share a first initial (e.g. twins) and the usual "J. Doe" style label would be ambiguous. The middle initial and surname are unaffected.

14. Choose your label sheet from **Label sheet** - Avery 5160, 5163, 14432, 14433, 14438, or a custom size.

15. Leave **Randomize which student gets which seat** checked to shuffle students across the allocated seats, or uncheck it to match your roster directly to seats in seat-ID order (this matches the Roster (TXT) numbering from Section 2 exactly, line for line). This checkbox is ignored - and disabled - when Seating style is set to "By instructor/section", since that mode always randomizes within each instructor/section group instead.

16. Choose **Print order** - **Classroom Map** (default) prints the stack by seat ID (A1, A2, … then B1, B2, …); **Alphabetical Order** prints it by last name instead. This only changes the order stickers come off the printer - it never changes which seat a student is assigned.

17. If a test print lands off-center on your label sheet, adjust **Nudge right** / **Nudge down** (in millimeters) and print again.

18. Click **Generate Stickers (PDF)**.

19. Print the downloaded PDF at **100% / Actual Size** - do not use "Fit to page" or any other scaling option, or the stickers will not line up with your label sheet.

20. Peel off each sticker and place it on that student's exam, in the order you chose above.

> Note: the roster you paste here is processed entirely in your browser to build the PDF - it is never uploaded or saved anywhere.

2. Generating a Numbered List (No Names) and Adding the Seat Column to Excel

If you'd rather keep names out of the process entirely and merge seat assignments into your own roster spreadsheet yourself, use the plain numbered list instead of stickers.

1. After clicking **Allocate Seats** (step 6 above), click **Roster (TXT)** to download `allocated_seats.txt`.
2. Each line of that file is just a sequence number, a tab, and a seat ID - no student names at all. It's numbered in seat-ID order (A1, A2, … then B1, B2, …), so **line *k* is the seat for student *k*** in your own roster, in whatever order you list them. For example:

   ```
   1	A1
   2	A14
   3	B7
   …
   ```

3. To add this seat column to your existing Excel roster:
   a. Open `allocated_seats.txt` in any text editor (Notepad, TextEdit, VS Code). Select all (**Ctrl+A** / **Cmd+A**) and copy (**Ctrl+C** / **Cmd+C**).
   b. In Excel, click the cell next to your first student's name and paste (**Ctrl+V** / **Cmd+V**). Excel splits the pasted text at the tab automatically - the sequence numbers land in one column and the seat IDs in the next.
   c. Delete the sequence-number column. What's left is your seat assignments, aligned row-for-row with your roster.

Alternative (Excel for Windows): *Data* → *From Text/CSV*, choose the file, set the delimiter to *Tab*, then untick the first column in the preview before clicking *Load*.

> Note: this file never contains student names, so it can be stored, shared, or emailed without exposing any student's identity.

A 500-student sample roster (roster_example_500.csv) is included alongside this guide, formatted for direct paste into the sticker roster box in Section 1 - paste as many rows from the top as match your class size, since no room holds all 500 at once. It demonstrates five example instructors sharing one room across thirteen sections, each instructor's name given only once per section and propagated automatically, plus a few students pinned to a specific seat, to try out with the "By instructor/section" seating style.